

Red Pitaya: Compact, versatile platform for electronics testing

The Red Pitaya board is reshaping the electronics testing landscape with its compact, Linux-based design. It offers a modern alternative to traditional bench-top tools by integrating FPGA, an analogue frontend, and a dual-core ARM Cortex-A9 processor. Whether you're a hobbyist, professional engineer, or educator, it provides a reprogrammable platform for signal measurement, analysis, and development, consolidating multiple functionalities into one device.

The board serves as a modern replacement for traditional tools like oscilloscopes, spectrum analyzers, and logic analyzers. It excels in various applications, including signal processing and power analysis for research and development, testing and troubleshooting digital and analogue circuits, and enabling remote management through SSH and SCPI commands for efficient control and monitoring. As an educational resource, it simplifies learning in electronics, signal processing, and FPGA programming, benefiting both beginners and advanced users.

Its open ecosystem supports Python, C, MATLAB, and LabVIEW, with FPGA customisation via Xilinx Vivado IDE. A web-based interface enables easy operation from any browser. An app marketplace extends its capabilities with pre-built and user-shared tools. Its reprogrammable nature, compact design, and cost efficiency make it a versatile choice. However, Ethernet dependency and a learning curve for FPGA programming may pose challenges. With multi-board synchronisation and an evolving app marketplace, Red Pitaya continues to adapt to emerging needs, cementing its role as a forward-looking platform for electronics testing and innovation.

Linux Foundation launches initiative to support Chromium browsers

The Linux Foundation has unveiled a new initiative called 'Supporters of Chromium-Based Browsers.' This program is designed to secure sustainable funding and foster collaborative development for projects within the Chromium ecosystem. By serving as a neutral platform, the initiative aims to bring together industry leaders, academic institutions, developers, and the broader open source community. Its primary objectives include breaking down barriers to innovation, promoting widespread adoption, and ensuring that projects within the Chromium ecosystem receive the necessary resources to thrive.



Jim Zemlin, executive director of the Linux Foundation, said: "With the launch of the Supporters of Chromium-Based Browsers, we are taking another step forward in empowering the open source community. This project will provide much-needed funding and development support for open development of projects within the Chromium ecosystem."

Importantly, the governance of Chromium projects will continue to remain under their existing management.

The initiative has already attracted significant backing from major players in the tech industry. Companies such as Google, Meta, Microsoft, and Opera have pledged their support, emphasising their commitment to advancing the Chromium ecosystem. Google, as the primary developer of Chromium, views this initiative as a pivotal step forward in the ecosystem's growth and sustainability.

Parisa Tabriz, VP of Chrome, said: "With the incredible support of the Linux Foundation, we believe the Supporters of Chromium-Based Browsers is an important opportunity to create a sustainable platform to support industry leaders, academia, developers, and the broader open source community in the continued development and innovation of the Chromium ecosystem."

The Linux Foundation will manage this initiative using an open governance approach, inspired by its own successful open source programs. This approach is built on core principles such as transparency, inclusivity, and a strong focus on community-driven development efforts.

A key component of this governance model is the establishment of a Technical Advisory Committee (TAC). This committee will play a crucial role in providing guidance and oversight for development activities, ensuring that the initiative's objectives align with the needs of the wider Chromium community.

As the backbone of many of the world's leading browsers, including Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, and Opera, Chromium powers browsers that account